

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 1♣X

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 6 2

♥ 10

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q 10 9 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ Q J 7 4 3

♦ K

♣ K 8 7 4



♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ A J 6 2

♠ K J 7 5

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥9.

And when North plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if North guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ A 6 5
 ♦ K J
 ♣ K Q 10 9 4

♠ K Q J 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ A 5



♠ A 10 4
 ♥ K 9 8
 ♦ A Q 8 4
 ♣ J 7 3

♠ 7 6

♥ Q J 10 7 3

♦ 10 5 3

♣ 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	1 ♠	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East partner's suit. If the lead turns out wrong, and the ♥Q lead would have beaten the contract, partner will not blame you in the least. But if you lead the ♥Q and it turns out that a ♠ lead would have let you set the contract, well, that would not be too good for partnership harmony.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠7, the suit your partner overcalled.

If partner had not overcalled, the ♥Q would be the perfect lead against 3NT. But partner DID overcall, perhaps to give you a hint on what to lead if East became declarer.

As you see, a ♠ lead will defeat the contract this time while the ♥Q would let declarer make 11 tricks.

Consider this: even if partner has a high ♥ to help you establish the suit it is not very likely that you would be able to get the lead with your entryless hand.

There is another, more subtle, reason for leading

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4
♥ A Q 10 7
♦ K Q 9 8
♣ 5

♠ 6 5 2

♥ 9 5 3 2

♦ A 6 4

♣ 9 4 2



♠ K 7

♥ 8 6 4

♦ J 7 2

♣ K Q J 10 8

♠ A J 9 3

♥ K J

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A 7 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

Dbl

All Pass

1♣X by South

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 1♣
doubled

Lead the ♣5.

There is only one reason partner would pass your
takeout double - he has a great ♣ suit and he expects
to inflict a large penalty.

What he wants do do is pull South's trumps so your
high card winners don't get ruffed by South. The way
you can help him do that is to start with a trump lead.

With the trump lead South might not make more than
three tricks.